

Lecture 3: Intro to proofs for algorithms

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601.433/633 Introduction to Algorithms
(Slides by Jessica Sorrell)

Today

Discuss common proof techniques for algorithms.

- ▶ Inductive arguments (weak, strong)
- ▶ Proof by contradiction
- ▶ Direct proof
- ▶ Loop invariant
- ▶ Proof by contrapositive

We'll demonstrate proof techniques by proving the correctness and running time of sorting algorithms you've seen before.

Quicksort review

Algorithm Quicksort

Input: array $\mathbf{A}$ of length n (assume all elements distinct)

- 1: **if** $n \leq 1$ **then**
 - 2: **return** $\mathbf{A}$
 - 3: **end if**
 - 4: Pick some element $p \in \mathbf{A}$ as the *pivot*
 - 5: Let $\mathbf{L}$ be the elements less than p , let $\mathbf{G}$ be the elements larger than p
 - 6: $\mathbf{L}' \leftarrow \text{Quicksort}(\mathbf{L})$
 - 7: $\mathbf{G}' \leftarrow \text{Quicksort}(\mathbf{G})$
 - 8: **return** $\mathbf{L}' \parallel p \parallel \mathbf{G}'$
-

Strong Induction vs Weak Induction

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- ▶ Prove property holds for a base case.
- ▶ e.g., Quicksort always returns a sorted array for input arrays of size $n \leq 1$.

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- ▶ Assume inductive hypothesis, that property holds *for all* $n \leq k$. Then show that property holds for $n = k + 1$.
- ▶ e.g. Assume Quicksort always returns a sorted array for input arrays of size $\leq k$. Show it returns a sorted array for input arrays of size $k + 1$.

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Weak induction:

- ▶ Prove property holds for a base case.
- ▶ Assume inductive hypothesis, that property holds for $n = k$. Then show that property holds for $n = k + 1$.
- ▶ e.g. Assume Quicksort always returns a sorted array for input arrays of size *exactly* k . Show it returns a sorted array for input arrays of size $k + 1$.

Correctness of Quicksort - (Strong) Inductive Proof

Claim: Given an array $\mathbf{A}$ of length n , Quicksort($\mathbf{A}$) returns an array with all elements of $\mathbf{A}$ sorted from least to greatest.

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 - ▶ $\mathbf{L}$ and $\mathbf{G}$ are of length $\leq n$, so by the inductive hypothesis, Quicksort($\mathbf{L}$) and Quicksort($\mathbf{G}$) return sorted arrays $\mathbf{L}'$ and $\mathbf{G}'$.

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 - ▶ Therefore $\mathbf{L}' \parallel p \parallel \mathbf{G}'$ is sorted.

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- ▶ A strong inductive hypothesis assumes the desired property holds for all $n \leq k$.
- ▶ Quicksort recursively calls itself on L and G , which we don't know the size of a priori.
- ▶ In strong induction, we assume that Quicksort is correct for all arrays of size $\leq k$, so it doesn't matter what the exact sizes of L and G are, because we know they are both $\leq k$.

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- ▶ Note $n \geq 2$.

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- ▶ So Quicksort($\mathbf{A}$) picks a pivot element $p \in \mathbf{A}$, defines $\mathbf{L}$ and $\mathbf{G}$ as the elements less than p and the elements greater than p respectively, and recursively calls Quicksort on $\mathbf{L}$ and $\mathbf{G}$ to get $\mathbf{L}'$ and $\mathbf{G}'$.

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- ▶ By the assumption that $\mathbf{A}$ is the smallest such array, $\mathbf{L}'$ and $\mathbf{G}'$ are sorted.
- ▶ Therefore $\mathbf{L}' \parallel p \parallel \mathbf{G}'$ is sorted.
- ▶ Contradiction: Quicksort($\mathbf{A}$) *does* return a sorted array.

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For a statement of the form $\mathbf{A} \Rightarrow \mathbf{B}$, a direct proof shows that $\mathbf{B}$ follows from the logical implications of $\mathbf{A}$.

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$$\begin{aligned}T(n) &= T(|L|) + T(|G|) + \Theta(n) = T(|L|) + T(n - 1 - |L|) + \Theta(n) \\&\leq T(n - 1) + T(0) + \Theta(n) = T(n - 1) + \Theta(n)\end{aligned}$$

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- ▶ Solve: $T(n) = \Theta(n^2)$.

Insertion Sort Review

Algorithm Insertion Sort

Input: array A of length n

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1: for  $i \leftarrow 2$  to  $n$  do  
2:    $j \leftarrow i$   
3:   while  $j > 1$  and  $A[j] < A[j - 1]$  do  
4:     Swap  $A[j]$  and  $A[j - 1]$   
5:      $j \leftarrow j - 1$   
6:   end while  
7: end for
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Proof by Loop Invariant (induction)

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Just induction on time!

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- ▶ Loop invariant: at the beginning of iteration i (or end of iteration $i - 1$), $\mathbf{A}[1, i - 1]$ contains all elements of the original input array $\mathbf{A}[1, i - 1]$, and is sorted.

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- ▶ Initialization - At the beginning of the first iteration $i = 2$, $\mathbf{A}[1]$ is sorted.
- ▶ Maintenance - In a single iteration, element $\mathbf{A}[i]$ of the input array is moved to the left until it is no longer smaller than the element to its left; therefore at the beginning of the next iteration, $\mathbf{A}[1, i]$ is sorted and contains exactly the same elements as $\mathbf{A}[1, i]$ from the original input array.

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- ▶ Termination - When the loop terminates, $i = n + 1$ and therefore $\mathbf{A}[1, n]$ is sorted and contains exactly the same elements as $\mathbf{A}[1, n]$ from the original input array. Therefore the original input array has been sorted.

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It relies on the fact that $P \Rightarrow Q$ is logically equivalent to $\neg Q \Rightarrow \neg P$.

To prove $P \Rightarrow Q$ by contrapositive, we show that if the negation of the conclusion is true ($\neg Q$), then the negation of the hypothesis is true ($\neg P$).

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- ▶ Let P : Inner loop terminates with counter $j > 1$.
- ▶ Let Q : $x \geq A[j - 1]$ at counter j .

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- ▶ We want to prove $P \Rightarrow Q$.
- ▶ **Contrapositive** ($\neg Q \Rightarrow \neg P$): If $x < A[j - 1]$ (with $j > 1$), then the inner loop does **not** terminate with counter value j .

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Contrapositive Goal ($\neg Q \Rightarrow \neg P$): If $x < A[j - 1]$ (for $j > 1$), the loop does not terminate with counter value j .

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 - ▶ Starts at $j = i$ with $A[i] = x$.
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- ▶ Since $j > 1$ and $A[j] < A[j - 1]$, the WHILE condition is **true**.

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By contrapositive, if it terminates with $j > 1$, then $x \geq A[j - 1]$.

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Master Theorem from last lecture (time permitting)

Master Theorem

$$T(n) = aT(n/b) + cn^k \qquad T(1) = c$$

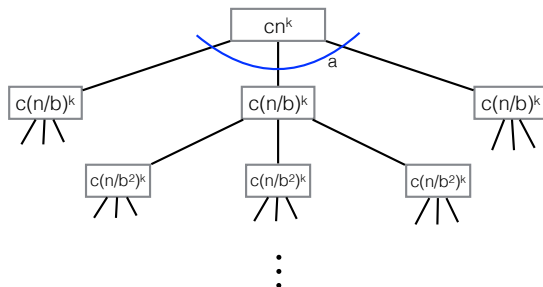
a, b, c, k constants with **$a \geq 1$** , **$b > 1$** , **$c > 0$** , and **$k \geq 0$**

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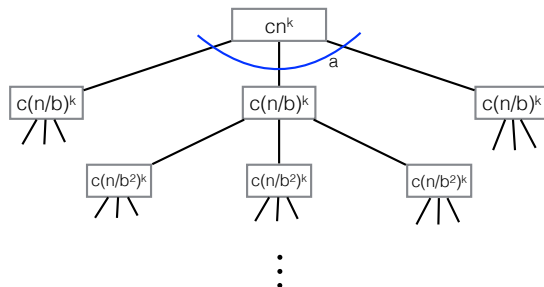


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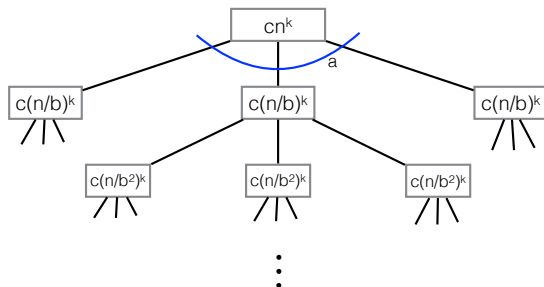
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a, b, c, k constants with $a \geq 1$, $b > 1$, $c > 0$, and $k \geq 0$



levels: $\log_b n + 1$

Level i : $a^{i-1}c(n/b^{i-1})^k = cn^k(a/b^k)^{i-1}$

Master Theorem II

Let $\alpha = (a/b^k)$

$$\implies T(n) = cn^k \sum_{i=1}^{\log_b n+1} (a/b^k)^{i-1} = cn^k \sum_{i=1}^{\log_b n+1} \alpha^{i-1}$$

Master Theorem II

Let $\alpha = (a/b^k)$

$$\implies T(n) = cn^k \sum_{i=1}^{\log_b n+1} (a/b^k)^{i-1} = cn^k \sum_{i=1}^{\log_b n+1} \alpha^{i-1}$$

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$$= O(\alpha^{\log_b n})$$

$$\begin{aligned} \implies T(n) &= \Theta(n^k \alpha^{\log_b n}) = \Theta(n^k (a/b^k)^{\log_b n}) = \Theta(a^{\log_b n}) \\ &= \Theta(n^{\log_b a}) \end{aligned}$$

Master Theorem III

Theorem (“Master Theorem”)

The recurrence

$$T(n) = aT(n/b) + cn^k$$

$$T(1) = c$$

where a, b, c , and k are constants with $a \geq 1$, $b > 1$, $c > 0$, and $k \geq 0$, satisfies

$$T(n) = \begin{cases} \Theta(n^k) & \text{if } a < b^k, \\ \Theta(n^k \log n) & \text{if } a = b^k, \\ \Theta(n^{\log_b a}) & \text{if } a > b^k. \end{cases}$$